Corrigendum-1 dated 21/07/2026

Request for Proposal (RFP) for Empanelment of Service Providers / Publishers for supply, licensing and access of e-Books for public libraries, Government of Gujarat
RFP# GIL/e-Gov/2026/e-Books
GeM Bid No:- GEM/2026/B/7581031

Please find the pre-BID queries responses

(All bidders are advised to carefully read and consider all Pre-Bid Queries and Responses.)

For more details, visit www.gil.gujarat.gov.in & www.gem.gov.in

Pre-Bid Queries Responses of Request for Proposal (RFP) for Empanelment of Service Providers / Publishers for supply, licensing and access of e-Books for public libraries, Government of Gujarat
RFP# GIL/e-Gov/2026/e-Books
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Sr No	RFP reference	Content/Clause of RFP requiring Clarification	Clarification Sought/Suggestion	Responses
1	Turnover of the bidder [2.A.2]	The RFP requests the average annual turnover for the financial years 2022-23, 2023-24, and 2024-25	As this tender is published in June 2026, the immediately preceding completed financial year is FY 2025-26. According to standard public procurement guidelines and rules, the turnover of the most recent financial year (FY 2025-26) must be taken into consideration to reflect the current financial capability of the bidders. ● Since finalized and audited financial statements for FY 2025-26 might still be under process for some vendors at this time of the year, the department should allow bidders to submit a Turnover Certificate issued by a Chartered Accountant (CA) for FY 2025-26. ● To safeguard the department's interests, a condition can be incorporated stating that selected vendors must submit their final Audited Balance Sheet and Profit & Loss statement within 3 months of empanelment, failing which their empanelment and any placed orders shall stand cancelled.	The financial years shall be revised to FY 2023-24, FY 2024-25 & FY 2025-26 or FY 2022-23, FY 2023-24 & FY 2024-25, if FY 2025-26 is unaudited.
2	Turnover of the bidder [2.A.2]	As this is the very first time the Department is floating a tender for E-books/E-	Therefore, under the term "Related Business Activities", the department must	Turnover from the supply/sale of physical books, library books,

		content in the state, the local language publishing market is traditionally based on printed materials. It is practically impossible for local language vendors to possess an exclusive turnover of INR 1.68 Crore solely from pure digital e-books over the previous financial years.	explicitly clarify and allow the turnover generated from the supply/sale of Physical Books, Library Books, and Printed Educational Materials to be considered valid for eligibility. Restricting it strictly to digital services will disqualify almost all veteran local publishers and language experts.	printed educational materials, and e-books/e-content shall be considered under related business activities.
3	Turnover of the bidder [2.A.2]	Unjustified Turnover Criteria vs Divided Empanelment Categories	Page 19 (Clause 1.1.8) specifies that the empanelment is divided into two separate categories: (1) Competitive categories and (2) Non-competitive categories. The scope also mandates a minimum of 50% competitive books and 70% content in the local Gujarati language. Since the orders will be distributed across categories and won't go to a single party, demanding a double turnover criteria (INR 1.68 Crore against an 84 Lakh bid value) restricts local vendors and violates competitive GeM procurement policies.	The minimum average annual turnover requirement has been revised from ₹1.68 crore to ₹1.50 crore to encourage wider competition while ensuring adequate financial and operational capability of bidders. All other terms and conditions of the bid shall remain unchanged.
4	Annexure-1	Objection to "Total Value Wise Evaluation" Method	A Total Value-Wise Evaluation is technically flawed for e-books. Books are intellectual property, not standard commercial commodities. Every book/content source is unique in terms of page count, quantity-wise utility, content quality, author's brand value, and publisher credibility. Awarding the tender strictly to the lowest total bidder (L1) means cheaper, lower-quality	The evaluation methodology shall be as specified in the RFP. Bidders are advised to submit the list of available e-books/content as Annexure-1 in accordance with the scope of work and other requirements prescribed in the bid document. The existing provision shall remain unchanged.

			content will outprice premium educational and local Gujarati literature.	
5	2.3.1	Request to Remove "Positive Net Worth" and "API Integration" Clauses	If a bidder can successfully deliver the required e-book subscriptions, historical net worth is irrelevant and acts as an entry barrier for local startups. Furthermore, forcing API single-window integration at this preliminary subscription stage is impractical and should be handled independently in future technical bids.	Positive Net Worth- As per RFP. No change in the Positive Net Worth criterion. API / EPUB Access Key- The requirement to provide API/EPUB Access Key may be made optional.

Corrigendum in Pre-Qualification Criteria in Section 2

Section	Criteria	Required Document as per Existing RFP	Updated Required Document as
Section-2	Turnover of the bidder	The bidder must have an average annual turnover of at least INR 1.68 Crore for FY 2022-23, 2023-24 and 2024-25. The turnover should be from e-Content/ Digital Services or related business activities. • Audited and Certified Balance Sheet & Profit/ Loss Account of last 3 Financial Years. • CA certificate clearly certifying the turnover requirements as per the clause.	The bidder must have an average annual turnover of at least INR 1.50 Crore for FY 2023-24, FY 2024-25 & FY 2025-26 or FY 2022-23, FY 2023-24 & FY 2024-25, if FY 2025-26 is unaudited. The turnover should be from e-Content/ Digital Services or related business activities, i.e. turnover from the supply/sale of physical books, library books, printed educational materials, and e-books/e-content etc. • Audited and Certified Balance Sheet & Profit/ Loss Account of FY 2023-24, FY 2024-25 & FY 2025-26 or FY 2022-23, FY 2023-24 & FY 2024-25, if FY 2025-26 is unaudited. • CA certificate clearly certifying the turnover requirements as per the clause.

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